

Philipp Hilbert. *AI Product Lead, Enterprise Knowledge & Workflow Automation.*

Positioning, 13 years owning AI and data products in regulated industries, now bringing that depth to Rakbank's Internal Productivity squad.

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§ WHY RAKBANK

Rakbank's AI Lab is doing something rarer than it sounds: treating internal productivity as a genuine product problem rather than an IT rollout. The explicit mandate to build an enterprise knowledge engine, democratize AI tooling across the bank, and measure adoption in real productivity and cost terms is the kind of scope where roadmap discipline and organizational trust matter as much as technical depth. The retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) architecture at the center of the knowledge engine maps directly onto patterns I have shipped in regulated settings: at the Federal Employment Agency I built and migrated the ETL backbone that fed a national labour-market analytics platform, and at Rohde & Schwarz I led an AI and data platform for a 15-engineer multinational team where pipeline runs doubled after I redirected strategy based on actual workflow data. *That combination of knowledge infrastructure ownership and measured adoption change is exactly the work I want to do at scale.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, paired coding and review
- **Cursor / VSCode**, day-to-day development environment
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping

- **GPT**, research, drafting, evaluation loops
 - **n8n**, agentic workflow orchestration
 - **Gamma.app**, stakeholder-facing decks and demos
 - **Framer**, design-heavy prototypes
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Kafka, Jira, Confluence, Miro, Figma, Azure DevOps, GitLab, Git, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT RAKBANK

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the AI Lab squads and interview AI Champions across departments to map where the knowledge engine breaks down in real workflows, before touching the roadmap.

WEEK 2

Slice the backlog.

Run a prioritisation session with knowledge owners and content teams to separate genuinely blocking retrieval gaps from cosmetic search complaints, and lock the first sprint scope.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, expand.

Deliver the first usable increment to a pilot department, instrument adoption with concrete KPIs, and use the data to make the next prioritisation decision rather than the last one.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Associate Vice President, Workflow Automation role at Rakbank. With thirteen years of product ownership in regulated industries, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, and fintech, I have spent most of that time doing exactly what the Internal Productivity squad needs: turning strategic intent into a working product, then persuading the organization to actually use it.

The enterprise knowledge engine is the part of this role I find most compelling. At the Federal Employment Agency I built the data platform that feeds national labour-market analytics to policymakers and researchers. That meant owning ETL migrations, introducing Dagster and dbt to remove manual hand-holding from quarterly imports, and integrating test automation into the Jenkins pipeline to free QA capacity. The underlying challenge, making institutional knowledge accessible, reliable, and fast, is structurally identical to what a retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) knowledge engine does for a bank. I understand how the plumbing needs to be built before the search experience can be trusted.

AI democratization is the other half of the mandate, and it is where I have seen the most common failure mode: tools deployed, adoption flat, no one measuring why. At Rohde & Schwarz I instrumented two competing developer workflows and discovered that the UI-led approach recorded exactly zero clicks. Redirecting to a code-first design doubled pipeline runs. That is the discipline I would apply to the bank's AI enablement program, playbooks grounded in observed behavior, not assumed preference, with measurable productivity gains as the success criterion rather than rollout headcount.

On squad leadership I have run a cross-functional team of fifteen-plus engineers and data scientists through Scrum in a multinational programme, restructured an eighteen-person delivery organisation that was losing senior engineers back into three lean teams with their own leads, bringing attrition from near-total exodus to a single departure, and taken products from concept to production in domains with no precedent. I am comfortable being accountable for delivery, team health, and stakeholder trust simultaneously.

Banking is a regulated environment I respect: governance, information security, and risk alignment are not friction to be worked around but constraints that define what responsible delivery looks like. My background as Deputy IT Security Officer and my work inside EU AI Act governance discussions means I engage those functions as peers, not as gates.

I would be glad to discuss how my experience maps to the specific priorities of the AI Lab. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

§ BEARING

Product manager with 13 years of ownership in regulated industries, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, payments, and fintech. I lead cross-functional squads through agile delivery, translate strategic priorities into prioritised roadmaps, and build AI and data products that demonstrably change how organizations work. At Rakbank I would apply that depth to the enterprise knowledge engine, AI enablement across the bank, and the squad leadership the Internal Productivity team needs to deliver at pace.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

AI Products and Tooling: large language model (LLM) agents, retrieval-augmented generation (RAG), agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI), Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, backlog management, prioritisation, MVP and PoC definition, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, go-to-market support, KPI definition

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, sprint review, retrospective, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, WIP limits, SAgile (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI planning

Analytics and Data: ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, funnel and churn analysis, Matomo, MicroStrategy

Knowledge Management and Enterprise Search: data platform product ownership, ETL pipeline design, search and retrieval architecture, knowledge governance, enterprise content workflows

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management

Governance and Business: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AND AEROSPACE AI 2024-2025

Led a 15-engineer cross-functional team delivering an internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme; GitOps rollout with ArgoCD cut deployment time from days to 30 minutes and workflow instrumentation doubled pipeline runs.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Owned national labour-market analytics platform; introduced Dagster and dbt reducing data-update time by 75%, integrated test automation into Jenkins, and migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2023

Cut an undeliverable roadmap to the top 10% of features; user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented CGM interface into hospital information system workflows, reducing digital anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean squads; attrition dropped from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS 2021-2022

Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT DATA 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE 2019-2020

Migrated a legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and 20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION
STAFFING 2025-PRESENT

Two-sided B2B marketplace, zero to one alone; LLM agents across the funnel, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, SQL funnel analysis.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · IT SECURITY 2016-2021

Quantum-secure encryption hardware and software; shipped a three-layer product installing in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · AGRITECH
2018-2021

Nanotechnology fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH 2013-2018

Mobile P2P group payments built from zero to acquisition; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native (C2). English, C2, business and technical fluency.

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